ACADEMIC CENTRAL

PRACTICE EXAMINATION

GRADE 8

ENGLISH FIRST ADDITIONAL LANGUAGE

PAPER 2 · PRACTICE B

MARKS: 60 **TIME: 2 hours**

Literature. Section A: Short story (25) · Section B: Poetry (20) · Section C: Drama (15). The texts are new to learners (unseen) and were written by Academic Central, so learners practise the literary skills used with any set work: narrator, setting, character, conflict, irony, symbolism, theme, imagery, figures of speech, rhyme, tone and stage directions.

Written by Academic Central for practice, following the CAPS curriculum for Grade 8. It is not a Department of Basic Education examination paper.

INSTRUCTIONS AND INFORMATION

1. This question paper consists of THREE sections: SECTION A: Short story (25 marks), SECTION B: Poetry (20 marks) and SECTION C: Drama (15 marks).
2. Answer ALL the questions.
3. Read each text carefully before you answer the questions on it.

SECTION A: SHORT STORY

QUESTION 1

Read the short story and answer the questions that follow.

The Borrowed Shoes

Thabo's brother Kamo had the fastest shoes in Soshanguve. They were white with a silver stripe, and Kamo cleaned them every Sunday with an old toothbrush, as carefully as a doctor cleaning instruments. "Nobody touches these," he told Thabo. "Not even you. Especially not you."

On the morning of the inter-school race, Kamo left early for his shift at the supermarket. The shoes sat on the shelf, shining like a promise. Thabo looked at his own takkies – grey, cracked, one sole held on with glue – and then at the silver stripe. *Just this once,* he thought. *He will never know.*

The shoes were two sizes too big. Thabo stuffed the toes with newspaper and laced them so tightly that his feet tingled. At the stadium, the other runners stretched and bounced. Thabo walked carefully, like someone crossing a river on stones.

When the starter's gun cracked, he shot forward. For fifty metres he was flying. Then the left shoe began to slip. By the bend it was flapping like a loose sail, and two runners passed him. Thabo did not think. He stopped, pulled off both shoes, threw them onto the grass and ran.

The track was hot and rough under his bare feet, but he was light now – lighter than he had ever been. He passed one runner, then another. In the last twenty metres he caught the boy from Mabopane and crossed the line half a step ahead of him. The crowd roared. Thabo bent over, gasping, and laughed at his dusty, burning feet.

Then he remembered the shoes.

They were not on the grass. His stomach turned to stone. He searched behind the benches, under the stands, everywhere. Nothing. He walked home slowly, the gold medal heavy around his neck, practising what he would say.

Kamo was sitting on the step. Next to him were the white shoes with the silver stripe – and a shoebox, still wrapped in plastic.

"Our neighbour saw you at the stadium," Kamo said. "She brought these back." He tapped the white shoes. Thabo opened his mouth, but no words came.

Kamo pushed the shoebox towards him. "I was going to give you these after the race. Your size." He paused. "But I hear you don't need shoes to win."

Thabo looked at the box, and then at his brother, who was trying very hard not to smile.

"I'm sorry," Thabo said. "I should have asked."

"Yes," said Kamo. "You should have." Then he grinned. "Now try them on. Properly, this time."

1.1 Name the setting (place) of the story. (1)

1.2 Who tells the story: a character in the story or an outside narrator? Give a reason. (2)

1.3 "… as carefully as a doctor cleaning instruments." Name the figure of speech and explain what it shows about Kamo. (3)

1.4 Why did Thabo decide to take the shoes? Give TWO reasons. (2)

1.5 "The shoes sat on the shelf, shining like a promise." What did the shoes "promise" Thabo? (1)

1.6 Describe the internal conflict that Thabo experiences in paragraph 2. (2)

1.7 Quote a simile from paragraph 4 that describes the loose shoe. (1)

1.8 Why did Thabo feel "light" when he ran without the shoes? Give TWO possible meanings. (2)

1.9 "His stomach turned to stone." Explain what this metaphor tells us about Thabo's feelings. (2)

1.10 Why was the medal "heavy around his neck" even though he had won? (2)

1.11 Explain the irony in the story. (2)

1.12 What do the borrowed shoes symbolise in the story? (2)

1.13 How does Kamo react when Thabo apologises? What does this show about him? (2)

1.14 What is the main theme (message) of the story? (1)

[25]

SECTION B: POETRY

QUESTION 2

Read the two poems and answer the questions on BOTH poems.

POEM 1: Load-shedding

At six o'clock the darkness walks in
without knocking,
switches off the fridge, the kettle, the TV,
and sits down with us at the table.

Mama lights a candle, a small brave flame
holding back the whole black night.
We have nothing to watch, so we watch each other.

Papa tells the story of the snake in the river,
the one we have heard a hundred times;
we laugh in all the same places.

At eight, the lights rush back, bright and loud –
and for a moment, nobody moves.

2.1 Name the figure of speech in lines 1–2 and explain what it suggests about the darkness. (2)

2.2 Why is the flame described as "brave" (line 5)? (2)

2.3 "We have nothing to watch, so we watch each other" (line 7). What is the effect of repeating the word "watch"? (2)

2.4 What do lines 9–10 tell us about the family? (2)

2.5 Why does "nobody move" when the lights come back (line 12)? (2)

POEM 2: My Grandmother's Hands

My grandmother's hands are rivers and roads,
They have carried water and heavy loads;
They kneaded the bread and they planted the maize,
They worked without stopping through hot summer days.

Her fingers are crooked, her knuckles are wide,
Yet they braid my hair with patience and pride;
And when I am frightened, or tired, or sad,
Those hands hold the softest touch I've had.

2.6 Write down the rhyme scheme of stanza 1. (2)

2.7 "My grandmother's hands are rivers and roads" (line 1). Name the figure of speech and explain what it suggests about her hands. (2)

2.8 Give TWO kinds of work the grandmother's hands have done. (2)

2.9 Which word in stanza 2 shows a contrast (a change in direction) in the poem? Explain the contrast. (2)

2.10 Describe the speaker's feelings towards the grandmother. Give a reason from the poem. (2)

[20]

SECTION C: DRAMA

QUESTION 3

Read the drama scene and answer the questions that follow.

The Wallet

Characters: SIPHO (13) · LERATO (13), his friend · MR MOLEFE, an elderly man
Setting: A busy taxi rank on a Friday afternoon.

(SIPHO and LERATO walk between parked taxis. SIPHO kicks something on the ground, then picks it up. It is a brown leather wallet.)

SIPHO: *(opening it, eyes wide)* Lerato! Look – there's money in here. Lots of it!

LERATO: *(leaning in)* How much?

SIPHO: *(counting quickly)* Eight hundred rand! We can buy the new football boots. Both of us!

LERATO: There's an ID card too. *(She pulls it out.)* Joseph Molefe. It's someone's money, Sipho.

SIPHO: *(shrugging)* Finders keepers. He should have been more careful.

LERATO: *(firmly)* And if it was your gogo's pension? Would you say "finders keepers" then?

(SIPHO is silent. He looks at the ID photo for a long time.)

(MR MOLEFE enters slowly, searching the ground and patting his pockets.)

MR MOLEFE: *(to himself, worried)* It was here … it must be here. My rent money …

LERATO: *(nudging SIPHO)* That's him.

(SIPHO hesitates, then walks over and holds out the wallet.)

SIPHO: *(quietly)* Excuse me, sir. Is this yours?

MR MOLEFE: *(clutching it to his chest)* Oh, thank you, my boy. Thank you! *(He opens it and counts.)* It's all here. *(He looks at SIPHO closely.)* You are Thandi Zulu's grandson, aren't you? I am the new coach at the community soccer club. We start trials on Saturday. Come – and bring your friend.

(SIPHO and LERATO look at each other and grin.)

LERATO: *(teasing)* Finders keepers?

SIPHO: *(laughing)* Keepers of the truth.

(Lights fade.)

3.1 Where and when does the scene take place? (2)

3.2 What is the main conflict in this scene? (2)

3.3 What does the stage direction "(SIPHO is silent. He looks at the ID photo for a long time.)" suggest about what Sipho is thinking? (2)

3.4 Which argument does Lerato use to change Sipho's mind? (1)

3.5 How does Mr Molefe feel when he enters? Quote ONE line to support your answer. (2)

3.6 Explain the irony in Sipho's reward. (2)

3.7 Explain the meaning of Sipho's last line, "Keepers of the truth." (2)

3.8 What lesson does this scene teach? (2)

[15]

TOTAL: 60

END OF QUESTION PAPER